

Design Principles

Why Report Formatting Matters



How visual hierarchy, typography, and spacing
transform readability

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Why this matters

- We're all submitting a report
- A good report = easier to read, higher clarity
- UI/UX isn't only for apps – it improves documents too

You may also get a better grade ;)

UI vs UX

UI = Visuals

> **Fonts**

> **Spacing**

> **Layout**

UI = Visuals

➤ **Fonts**

➤ **Spacing**

➤ **Layout**

UX = Experience

➤ **Flow**

➤ **Readability**

➤ **Navigation**

Design Principles

1 Visual Hierarchy

2 Typography

3 Spacing & Layout

Create a clear path for the reader's eye

Key Principles

Size, weight, and contrast establish importance

Create a clear path for the reader's eye

Before

Q4 Revenue Report

\$2.4M total revenue

23% increase from Q3

Key insights and recommendations

Target exceeded by 12%

Everything looks the same—no clear priority

Key Principles

Size, weight, and contrast establish importance

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After

Q4 Revenue Report
\$2.4M
↑ 23% increase from Q3

Target exceeded by 12%

Clear structure guides attention to what matters

Key Principles

Size, weight, and contrast establish importance

The foundation of readable reports

Font Choice

Use 1-2 fonts maximum

Sans-serif for headings (clarity)

Serif for body text (readability)

Line Length

50-75 characters per line

This is the optimal line length for comfortable reading. Too wide causes eye strain, too narrow feels choppy.

Contrast

Ensure sufficient contrast

Too light

Just right

The foundation of readable reports

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Example

Executive Summary

The fourth quarter demonstrated strong performance across all key metrics. Revenue increased by 23% year-over-year, driven primarily by enterprise client acquisitions.

Key Findings

- Customer retention improved to 94%
- Average deal size grew by 18%
- Market share expanded by 3 points

Clear structure guides attention to what matters

White space is a design element, not wasted space

Margins

Create breathing room around content

Grouping

Related items should be close together

Consistency

Use a spacing scale (8px, 16px, 24px...)

White space is a design element, not wasted space

Before

Sales Performance Review

\$847K

Target: \$800K

Previous: \$723K

Top performer: Yaseen Alfaraj

Conversion rate: 34%

Next review: Dec 15

Hard to scan, overwhelming

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Sales Performance Review

\$847K

Target	Previous
\$800K	\$723K

Highlights

Top performer: Yaseen Alfaraj

Conversion rate: 34%

Easy to scan, clear grouping

Margins

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Fixing a Bad Design

Before

What Is Good UI/UX Design?
Good UI/UX design is all about creating interfaces that feel natural and effortless to use. It presents information clearly, uses consistent patterns, and guides users through visual hierarchy rather than instructions. A well-crafted design reduces confusion, supports user goals, and makes interactions smooth and intuitive. When everything works together seamlessly, the design becomes almost invisible — users simply accomplish what they need without thinking about the interface itself.

Fixing a Bad Design

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Good design is often invisible, it just feels right.

- John Hench

Thank You



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